

A+E

‘WELCOME’ HOME

Variety show wants to feel like hanging out with friends in their Lincoln Square basement.

ADDISON ANNIS/FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

REAL ESTATE

The 10 priciest ZIP codes for Chicago homebuyers

LIFE+TRAVEL

A ticket to ride at Italy’s supercar factories

Move toward de-extinction of animals raises flags

Experts cite concerns over process in wake of ‘return’ of dire wolf

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

As the Trump administration slashes funding for health, energy and climate research, there’s one science the administration is promoting: de-extinction.

Earlier this month, a biotechnology company announced it had genetically engineered three gray wolf pups to have white hair, more muscular jaws and a larger build — characteristics of the dire wolf, a species that hasn’t roamed the Earth for several millennia.

Now, the Trump administration is citing the case of the dire wolf as it moves to reduce federal protections under the Endangered Species Act of 1973. On Wednesday, the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service and National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration announced a proposed rule to rescind the definition of “harm” under the act — which for decades has included actions like harassing, pursuing, hunting or killing endangered wildlife and plants, as well as habitat destruction.

“The status quo is focused on regulation more than innovation. It’s time to fundamentally change how we think about species conservation,” said Interior Secretary Doug Burgum in an April 7 post on X, formerly Twitter. “The revival of the Dire Wolf heralds the advent of a thrilling new era of scientific wonder, showcasing how the concept of ‘de-extinction’ can serve as a bedrock for modern species conservation.”

But bioethicists and conservationists are expressing unease with the kind of scientific research being pioneered by Colossal Biosciences, a Dallas-based company on a mission to bring back extinct animals.

“Unfortunately, as clever as this science is ... it’s can-do science and not should-do science,” said

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A police dog sniffs newly arriving detainees in an underground tunnel at Cook County Jail in Chicago on Wednesday. ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE

Officials weigh why jail population again on rise

Experts point to a number of reasons, from arrest rates to judicial decision-making

By Madeline Buckley and Joe Mahr
Chicago Tribune

Early in the morning outside Cook County Jail, a group of new detainees stepped out of a Chicago police wagon and walked bleary-eyed into the bright sunlight before lining up inside against a brick wall.

Brought in from the police districts, the men were among the newest bookings to the jail, where they would wait until a judge ruled on whether they would be admitted or released while their charges were pending.

And the jail, busy during the early morning hours as police brought in overnight arrestees and deputies shuttled detainees to court appearances, may only grow more bustling: After a decline following statewide bail reform — and years of reductions prior to that — the county’s jail population has begun to tick up once again.

In an internal report obtained by the Tribune via a public records request, the Cook County sheriff’s office found that the average daily jail population has risen by about 12% in recent months, reaching its highest level in eight months at the end of March. The report also found sharp increases in detention for some charge types for which State’s Attorney Eileen O’Neill Burke has implemented policy changes.

Many factors can influence the ebb and flow of the jail’s population, and experts pointed to a number of potential considerations when evaluating it, including arrest rates and judicial decision-making.

The sheriff’s office’s analysis, the report said, sought to understand the impact of the policies of Burke, who was ceremonially sworn in on Dec. 2.

Sheriff Tom Dart, in an interview with the Tribune, made clear that he supports policies that keep high-risk defendants incarcerated, but said he is concerned about how long inmates remain in jail as court cases move sluggishly through the system.

In 2023, the Tribune’s Stalled

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State looks to rein in drug intermediaries over high costs

Legislation remains unresolved; industry says efforts are flawed

By Lisa Schencker and Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

New patients have recently begun streaming into Del-Kar Pharmacy — an independent, 65-year-old drugstore in North Lawndale — after nearby Walgreens stores closed.

The new customers would be a blessing for many businesses, but for Del-Kar it means losing money on many prescriptions. The reimbursements the drugstore receives for filling orders are often less than the cost of fill-

ing them, said second-generation owner and pharmacist Edwin Muldrow.

He traces the trend to the rise of pharmacy benefit managers, or PBMs — companies that act as intermediaries among drugmakers, insurance corporations and pharmacies.

Independent pharmacy owners have long complained that PBMs are part of massive conglomerates that have led to higher out-of-pocket costs for patients. They say PBMs steer patients to pharmacies in which they have a financial interest, don’t reimburse pharmacies enough for medications and don’t adequately pass along rebates

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INSIDE

BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Bulls are broken

With no clear path forward, why aren’t seats hotter for Bulls’ Artūras Karnišovas and Billy Donovan?

Julia Poe in Chicago Sports

Deportations halted

The Supreme Court blocked the deportations of Venezuelans held in north Texas under an 18th-century wartime law.

Nation & World